CS:5980
Foundations of Embedded Systems

Liveness Requirements
Part I

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From Desktops to Cyber-Physical Systems

Traditional computers: Stand-alone devices running software applications

- e.g., data processing

Traditional controllers: Devices interacting with physical world via sensors and actuators

- e.g., thermostat

Embedded (aka Cyber-physical) Systems: Special-purpose system with integrated microcontroller/software

- e.g., cameras, watches, washing machines, …

Formal Verification



How to formalize requirements?

1. **Safety requirements:** Invariants, monitors
2. **Liveness requirements:** Temporal logic formulas

Recap: Safety Requirements

Nothing bad ever happens

- Trains should not be on bridge simultaneously
- If the east train is waiting, the west train should not be allowed on the bridge twice in succession

Violation of a safety property is provable by a (finite) execution prefix

Recap: Safety Requirements

Formalization:

- Identify a property φ over state variables, and check if φ is an invariant of the given system S, or
- Construct a monitor M and check that "monitor mode is not error" is an invariant of the composite system S || M

Analysis:

- Proof based on inductive invariants
- Algorithms for exploring the reachable states of the system

Liveness Requirements

Something good eventually happens

- A waiting train is eventually allowed to enter the bridge
- Each process eventually decides to be a leader / follower

Violation of a liveness property is not provable by a (finite) execution prefix

- but is provable by an execution where the system gets stuck in a cycle without achieving the goal

Liveness Requirements

Formalization:

- Need to consider infinite executions (ω-executions)
- Need a logic to state properties of such executions

Analysis:

- Proof typically based on automata constructions
- Special cases admit logical proofs

Temporal Logics

Logics proposed to reason about time

- Origins in philosophy
- Tense logic: Prior (1920)

Linear Temporal Logic (LTL) proposed to reason about executions of reactive systems

- Pnueli (1977), later selected for Turing award (1996)

Industrial adoption

- Property Specification Language (PSL) IEEE standard
- LTL enriched with many additional constructs for usability
- Supported by CAD tools for simulation/analysis of Verilog/VHDL

Valuations and Base Formulas

V: set of typed variables

- Example: nat x, bool y

Valuation: type-consistent assignment of values to variables in V

- q_0 : (x = 26, y = 0)
- q_1 : (x = 11, y = 1)

Base formula: Boolean-valued expression over V

- even(x)
- (y = 0) ⇒ even(x)

Satisfiability: valuation q satisfies formula φ, written $q \models \varphi$, if $q(\varphi)$ evaluates to 1

- $q_0 \models$ even(x)
- $q_0 \models$ (y = 0) ⇒ even(x)
- $q_1 \not\models$ even(x)
- $q_1 \models$ (y = 0) ⇒ even(x)

Traces

A base formula expresses a property of a single valuation

Trace: Infinite sequence of valuations

- ρ : (0,0), (1,1), (2,0), (3,1), (4,0), (5,1), …
- ρ' : (0,0), (21,1), (13,1), (43,0), …

In system specification and verification, V can be one of the following:

- The set of state variables
  (a trace is a possible infinite *execution* of the system)
- The set of input and output variables
  (a trace is an observed *input/output behavior* of system)
- **The set of all state, input, and output variables**

LTL Basics

A base formula expresses a property of single valuation

Trace: Infinite sequence of valuation

LTL formulas φ are built from Boolean-valued expressions using

- **Logical connectives:** $_ \wedge _$, $_ \vee _$, $_ \Rightarrow _$, $\neg _$ (and, or, implies, not)
- **Temporal operators:** Always $_$, Eventually $_$, Next $_$, $_$ Until $_$

  $\Box _$, $\Diamond _$, $\bigcirc _$, $_ \, U \, _$

Note: Base formula are just formulas with no temporal operators

LTL formulas are evaluated with respect to a trace

A trace $\rho = q_1, q_2, q_3, \ldots$ *satisfies* a base formula φ if $q_1 \models \varphi$ (i.e., assignment q_1 satisfies φ)

Always Operator

Always φ intuitively means φ holds at all times

For a base formula φ, a trace $\rho = q_1, q_2, q_3, \ldots$ *satisfies* Always φ if $q_j \models \varphi$ for all $j > 0$

Example: Trace

x:	0	1	2	3	4	5	…
y:	0	1	0	1	0	1	…

- *falsifies* (i.e., does not satisfy) Always even(x)
- satisfies Always (y = 0 ⇒ even(x))

Note: A state property φ is invariant for a transition system T iff every execution of T (seen as a trace) satisfies Always φ

Eventually Operator

Eventually φ intuitively means φ holds at some point (at least once)

For a base formula φ, a trace $\rho = q_1, q_2, q_3, \ldots$ *satisfies* Eventually φ if $q_j \vDash \varphi$ for some $j > 0$

Example: Trace

x:	0	1	2	3	4	5	…
y:	0	1	0	1	0	1	…

- satisfies Eventually (y = 1)
- satisfies Eventually (x = 45)
- falsifies Eventually (x = 4 ∧ y = 1)

Note: Eventually is the logical dual of Always:

a trace ρ satisfies Eventually φ iff ρ satisfies $\neg$Always $\neg\varphi$ iff

ρ falsifies Always $\neg\varphi$

Next Operator

Next φ intuitively means φ holds the *next* time

For a base formula φ, a trace $\rho = q_1, q_2, q_3, \ldots$ *satisfies* Next φ if $q_2 \models \varphi$

Example: Trace

x:	0	1	2	3	4	5	…
y:	0	1	0	1	0	1	…

- satisfies Next (y = 1)
- falsifies Next (x = 2)

Until Operator

φ Until ψ intuitively means ψ holds at some point and φ holds at all times until then

For base formulas φ, ψ, a trace $\rho = q_1, q_2, q_3, \ldots$ satisfies φ Until ψ
if $q_j \vDash \psi$ for some $j > 0$ and $q_i \vDash \varphi$ for all $i < j$

Example: Trace `x: 0 0 0 2 2 5 …`

- satisfies (x = 0) Until (x = 2)
- satisfies (x <= 2) Until (x = 5)
- Satisfies (whatever) Until (x = 0)

Note: If a trace satisfies φ Until ψ, it must also satisfy Eventually ψ

Formulas with Nested Temporal Operators

Which traces satisfy Next Always φ where φ is a base formula?

- Trace $\rho = q_1, q_2, q_3, \ldots$ satisfies Next Always φ if $q_j \models \varphi$ for all $j > 1$

To formalize this, we need to define the relation $(\rho, j) \models \varphi$ (ρ *satisfies* φ *at position* j) for arbitrary temporal formulas

- Same as *suffix* trace $q_j, q_{j+1}, q_{j+2}, \ldots$ (starting at position j) *satisfies* φ

$(\rho, j) \models \varphi$	if $q_j \models \varphi$ if φ is a base formula
$(\rho, j) \models \neg \varphi$	if $(\rho, j) \not\models \varphi$
$(\rho, j) \models \varphi_1 \wedge \varphi_2$	if $(\rho, j) \models \varphi_1$ and $(\rho, j) \models \varphi_2$
$(\rho, j) \models \varphi_1 \vee \varphi_2$	if $(\rho, j) \models \varphi_1$ or $(\rho, j) \models \varphi_2$
$(\rho, j) \models \varphi_1 \Rightarrow \varphi_2$	if $(\rho, j) \not\models \varphi_1$ or $(\rho, j) \models \varphi_2$

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- Same as *suffix* trace $q_j, q_{j+1}, q_{j+2}, \ldots$ (starting at position j) *satisfies* φ

$(\rho, j) \models$ Next φ	if $(\rho, j + 1) \models \varphi$
$(\rho, j) \models$ Always φ	if $(\rho, k) \models \varphi$ for all positions $k \geq j$
$(\rho, j) \models$ Eventually φ	if $(\rho, k) \models \varphi$ for some position $k \geq j$
$(\rho, j) \models \varphi_1$ Until φ_2	if there is a position $k \geq j$ such that $(\rho, i) \models \varphi_1$ for all $i = j \ldots k - 1$ and $(\rho, k) \models \varphi_2$

Trace ρ *satisfies* temporal formula ψ iff $(\rho, 1) \models \psi$

Example Traces

Time steps	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	…											
p (state prop.)	•	•	•	•	•		•	•	•	•	•				•	•	•	•	•	•	•	…
q (state prop.)						•								•	•							…
Next p	•	•	•	•		•	•	•	•	•				•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	…
Eventually q	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•							…
Always p															•	•	•	•	•	•	•	…
p **Until** q	•	•	•	•	•	•								•	•							…
¬ p						•						•	•	•								…
p ∧ q															•							…
p ∨ q	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	…

• = true blank = false

Multiple Eventualities

Example: Multi-agent system where multiple goals have to be satisfied

- Goal1: Robot 1 has finished its mission
- Goal2: Robot 2 has finished its mission

Spec, version 1: (Eventually Goal1) $\wedge$ (Eventually Goal2)

- Trace ρ satisfies this spec if there are positions i, j such that $(\rho, i) \models$ Goal1 and $(\rho, j) \models$ Goal2
- **Note:** no specific order in which goals are to be achieved

Spec, version 2: Eventually [Goal1 $\wedge$ (Eventually Goal2)]

- Trace ρ satisfies this spec if there are positions i, j such that $i \leq j$ and $(\rho, i) \models$ Goal1 and $(\rho, j) \models$ Goal2

Spec, version 3: Eventually [Goal1 $\wedge$ Next (Eventually Goal2)]

- Trace ρ satisfies this spec if there are positions i, j such that $i < j$ and $(\rho, i) \models$ Goal1 and $(\rho, j) \models$ Goal2

Recurrence and Persistence

Repeatedly φ = Always Eventually φ

- i.e., for all ρ and for all j, $(\rho, j) \models$ Eventually φ
- i.e., for all ρ and for all j, there is an $i \geq j$ such that $(\rho, i) \models \varphi$
- i.e., for all ρ, there are infinitely many suffixes of ρ that satisfy φ

Persistently φ = Eventually Always φ

- i.e., for all ρ and for some j, $(\rho, j) \models$ Always φ
- i.e., for all ρ, there is a j such that for all $i \geq j$, $(\rho, i) \models \varphi$
- i.e., for all ρ, formula φ is satisfied eventually and stays satisfied

The two patterns are logical duals:

- a trace ρ satisfies Repeatedly φ iff it falsifies Persistently $\neg\varphi$

Exercise

Trace:

x:	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7 …
y:	0	1	0	1	0	1	0	1 …

Which of the following formulas are satisfied by the trace above?

1. Repeatedly (y = 0)
2. Persistently (x ≥ y)
3. Always [even(x) ⇒ Next odd(x)]
4. Always [even(y) ⇒ Next odd(x)]
5. Repeatedly prime(x)

Requirements-based Design

Given:

- Input/output interface of system C to be designed
- Model E of the environment
- LTL-formula φ over I/O variables and state variables of the environment model E

Design problem:

Fill in details of C so that every infinite execution of the composition of E and C satisfies φ

Applies to synchronous as well as asynchronous designs

Leader Election

Requirements refer to output variable $status_n$ of each node n

Liveness: Each node n eventually decides its status

$$\text{Eventually} (status_n = \text{leader} \vee status_n = \text{follower})$$

Safety: For distinct nodes m, n, if m decides to be a leader at any point at all, then n can never be a leader

$$\text{Eventually} (status_m = \text{leader}) \Rightarrow \text{Always} \neg(status_n = \text{leader})$$

Railroad Controller

Requirements refer to mode variables of trains and I/O variables (signals)

Safety: The two trains should not be on bridge simultaneously

$$\text{Always } \neg(\text{mode}_W = \text{bridge} \wedge \text{mode}_E = \text{bridge})$$

Liveness 1: West train gets on bridge repeatedly

$$\text{Repeatedly } (\text{mode}_W = \text{bridge})$$

Not a good spec (why?), no controller can satisfy this

Liveness 2: A waiting west train is eventually allowed to enter

$$\text{Always } [\ (\text{mode}_W = \text{wait}) \Rightarrow \text{Eventually } (\text{signal}_W = \text{green})\ ]$$

Note: LTL helps clarify ambiguities in English sentences. Liveness 2 is not satisfied by our controller (what is a counterexample?) What if east train never leaves the bridge?

Railroad Controller

Liveness 2': Liveness 2 conditioned upon east train not staying on bridge forever

Repeatedly $\neg(mode_E = bridge) \Rightarrow (Always[\ (mode_W = wait) \Rightarrow Eventually\ (signal_W = green)\ ])$

Does either of the two controllers in Chapter 3 satisfy this?

Liveness 3: If west train is waiting, then eventually either it is allowed to enter bridge or east train is on bridge (implies absence of deadlocks)

$Always\ [\ (mode_W = wait) \Rightarrow (Eventually\ (signal_W = green\ \ \vee\ mode_E = bridge\ )\ ])$

Writing precise requirements is challenging but crucial!

Credits

Notes based on Chapter 5 of

Principles of Cyber-Physical Systems
by Rajeev Alur
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